INFINITE HORIZON

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Listen to ambient examples. Begin building a drone/pad foundation.	Slides 1–7: hook, what the project is, the steps, five words, steps 1 and 2. Hand out the project sheet and the Listening log. You choose and play the examples; none is included.	Slides 1–7	p. 12, p. 16, p. 17, p. 18, p. 20
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Layer additional textures and atmospheric elements.	Slides 8–10: four phases, texture not rhythm, step 3. Hand out the Phase plan. Check each drone layer is in place.	Slides 8–10	p. 13
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — automate, refine, evolve the soundscape.	Slides 11–13: automate everything, step 4 and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Automation plan. Then work time.	Slides 11–13	p. 14
CLASS 4		Slides 14–15: patience, and refine. Hand out the Listen-back sheet. Then work time.	Slides 14–15	p. 15
CLASS 5		Full working day: automate, refine, evolve. Ask each student to play the first 20 seconds and say what changes in it.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 16–18: mix and bounce, what to turn in, the rubric. Students post their three Padlet questions.	Slides 16–18	p. 19, p. 21
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 19–20: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions. Reflection (page 22) follows the presentations.	Slides 19–20	p. 21, p. 22

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

Say it twice: this is texture and motion, not rhythm (my first struggle). If a student adds a beat, ask what they would hear if the beat were taken out.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate with one question: what is moving in your piece right now?

PREVIEW

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INFINITE HORIZON

Worked example · an invented piece

EXAMPLE

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Slow Tide", described on paper**: no audio is included. Students' projects will differ.

1 · A WEAK PLAN

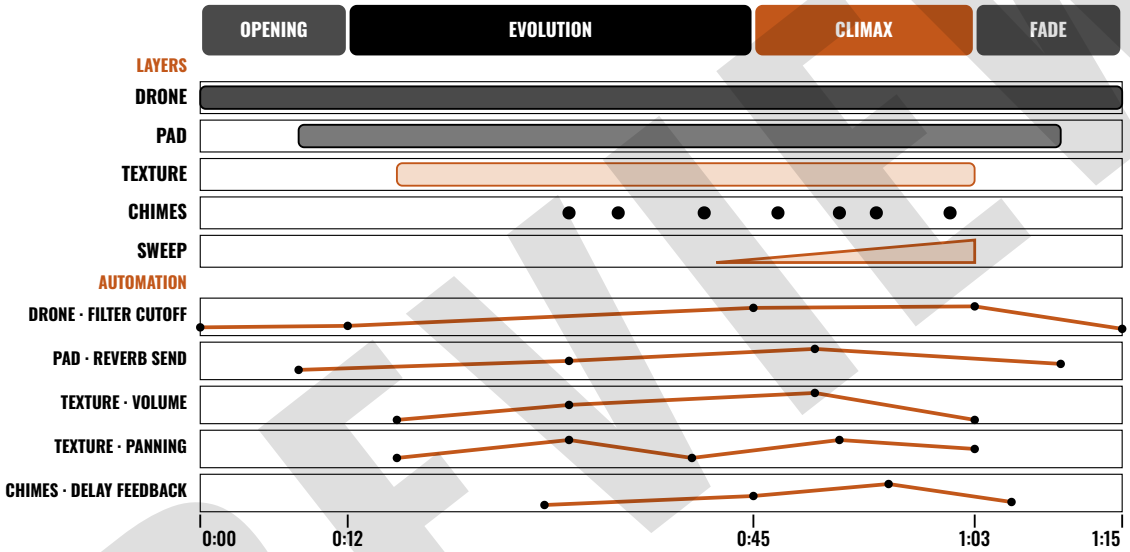
I will make a calm ambient track with a soft beat.

It has a beat, and nothing says what will change.

2 · A CLEAR PLAN

I am making "Slow Tide", a 75-second soundscape about the sea coming in. It has no beat. It opens with a low drone, a pad joins at 8 seconds, and noise and bell notes arrive in the evolution. I will automate the drone's filter, the pad's reverb, the texture's volume and panning and the chimes' delay: five lanes, so nothing stays the same. It climbs to a swell at 45 seconds and fades to the drone alone.

3 · THE MAP: 1:15, FOUR PHASES, FIVE LAYERS, FIVE LANES ·



4 · PHASES

Opening	0:00–0:12	the drone alone, filter nearly closed; the pad joins at 0:08
Evolution	0:12–0:45	texture and chimes arrive; the filter and reverb open slowly; the texture pans left and right
Climax	0:45–1:03	the sweep rises, everything is at its fullest and widest, the chimes echo the most
Fade	1:03–1:15	texture and sweep leave, the pad fades, the filter closes on the drone

5 · LAYERS (IN TO OUT)

Drone	one low, sustained synth chord that never stops	0:00–1:15
Pad	a soft, wide synth pad that slowly joins	0:08–1:10
Texture	filtered noise, like wind far away	0:16–1:03
Chimes	a few soft bell notes, no pulse, long reverb	0:28–1:06
Sweep	a noise swell that rises into the climax	0:42–1:03

6 · AUTOMATION LANES

Drone · filter cutoff	0:00–1:15
Pad · reverb send	0:08–1:10
Texture · volume	0:16–1:03
Texture · panning	0:16–1:03
Chimes · delay feedback	0:28–1:06

7 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

12 + 33 + 18 + 12 = 75 s = 1:15, inside my 60–90 second range. Five lanes, my Harder variation's minimum, and every one moves a lot. **Three Padlet questions (invented):** 1. Where did you first notice something change? 2. Which layer could you hear moving, and which was still? 3. Did your eyes-closed picture match the title?

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INFINITE HORIZON

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Length: 60–90 seconds
- ☐ Layer ambient textures and drones using synths, samples, and FX
- ☐ Use automation to change parameters over time (filters, reverb, volume)
- ☐ Incorporate gradual transitions and evolving movement
- ☐ Avoid traditional rhythm or song structure — focus on motion and space

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Listen** — Study examples of ambient and soundscape music for inspiration (Listening log: page 12)
2. **Build your foundation** — Create a drone or pad layer as your base texture (Phase plan: page 13)
3. **Layer** — Add additional textures, sounds, and atmospheric elements
4. **Automate** — Draw automation on filters, reverb, volume, and panning to create evolution (Automation plan: page 14)
5. **Refine** — Listen for flow and pacing. Remove anything that feels static or repetitive. (Listen-back sheet: page 15)
6. **Finalize** — Mix for depth and space. Bounce your soundscape.
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Infinite Horizon | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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